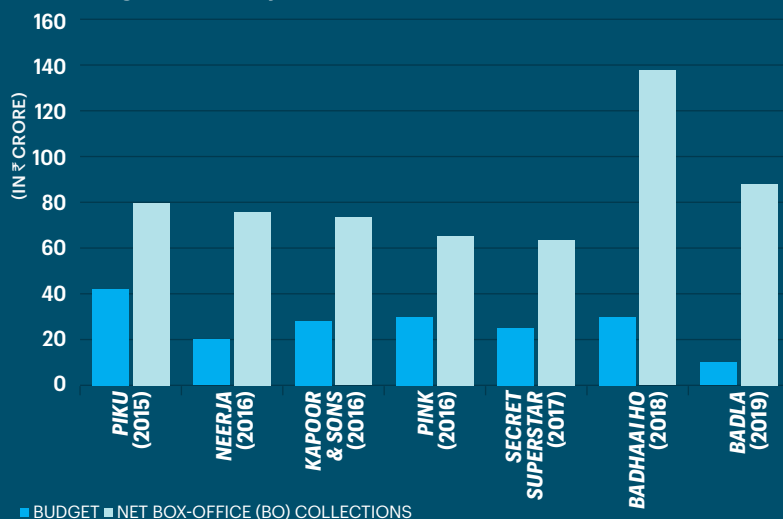


## HUMBLE BUT NIMBLE

Before the pandemic, medium-budget Bollywood hits used to make good money at the domestic box office



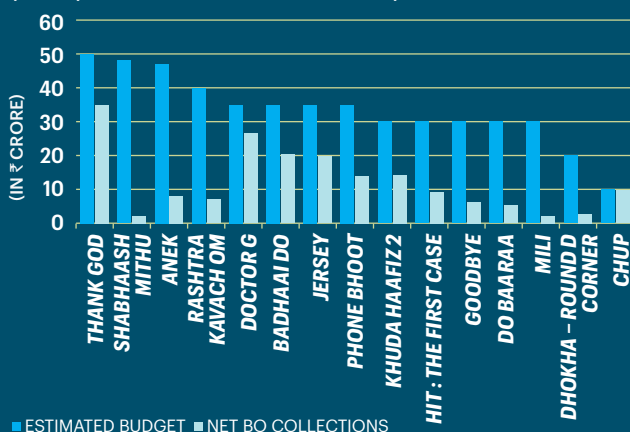
■ BUDGET ■ NET BOX-OFFICE (BO) COLLECTIONS

RELEASE YEARS IN BRACKETS; BUDGET DATA FROM TRADE PORTALS; BO COLLECTIONS FROM BOLLYWOOD HUNGAMA



## LOSING THEIR ALLURE

Most small- and medium-budget movies released post-pandemic have lost money at the box office

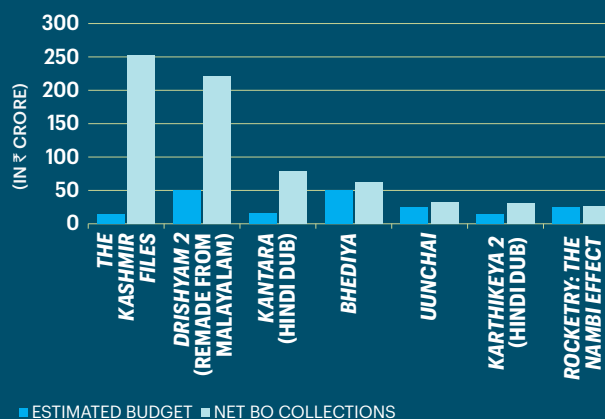


■ ESTIMATED BUDGET ■ NET BO COLLECTIONS

**NOTE** SOME OF THE SMALL- AND MEDIUM-BUDGET FLOP HINDI MOVIES IN 2022; LIST NOT EXHAUSTIVE; BUDGET DATA FROM TRADE PORTALS; BO COLLECTIONS FROM BOLLYWOOD HUNGAMA

## SOLITARY GEMS

However, some small- and medium-budget movies have done better than expected



■ ESTIMATED BUDGET ■ NET BO COLLECTIONS

**NOTE** BUDGET ESTIMATES FOR KANTARA (KANNADA ORIGINAL) AND FOR KARTHIKEYA 2 (TELUGU ORIGINAL); BUDGET DATA FROM TRADE PORTALS; BO COLLECTIONS FROM BOLLYWOOD HUNGAMA

It shows us the producer has confidence in the content. Also, it helps the overall marketing of a film," says Ajit Thakur, CEO of Tamil and Telugu OTT platform aha. For OTTs, it makes sense to pick up the so-called "sure-shot" films to ensure a good return on investment. These films have already done business at the box office and don't require marketing spends because viewers would know about them. Netflix,

for instance, has been picking up the rights of most of the theatrical hits across Tamil, Telugu and Hindi, including blockbuster *RRR* in Hindi.

Jaisingh says *Rocketry: The Nambi Effect*, a film distributed by UFO, must have made 30-35 per cent of its revenue from the theatres and the rest from the sale of digital and satellite rights. "But that [70 per cent] came in because you had the foundation of the theatrical release," he

says. "Today, it's critical for a small- or medium-budget film to perform well theatrically. Otherwise, OTT platforms will not touch it, unless it goes at a low price in a bundle of 5-10 movies," he says.

This is an echo of what's happening globally, experts say. All major media companies such as Netflix, Amazon and the Big Five studios—Universal Pictures, Paramount Pictures, Warner Bros., Walt Disney